

YEAR-2025(1) | VOLUME-1 | ISSUE: 3 | (JULY TO SEPTEMBER) | FREQUENCY- QUARTERLY | PRINT (ISSN): 3107-4901
Starting Year-2025 Multidisciplinary Subjects & Multiple Languages: Hindi, Sanskrit, English, Urdu, Punjabi Etc. (All Regional Languages)
International Indexing in (IIFS) : Impact Factor: 3.0
A peer-reviewed research journal published as per UGC norms is a valid journal as per the UGC Gazette Notification (Gazette of India, Extraordinary Part-III, Section-4, dated 18th July, 2018).

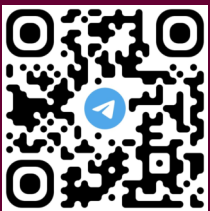
श्रीशोधमंत्र

अंतरराष्ट्रीय बहुविषयक शैक्षणिक रिसर्च जर्नल
(अंतरराष्ट्रीय बहुविषयक पियर रिव्यूड एवं रेफरीड 'समीक्षित एवं मूल्यांकित' शोध पत्रिका)



Shreeshodhmantra

International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
(An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)



Publishing Body:

SSM Publication, Maddmaheshwar Road
Ukhimath, Gandhinagar Ward No-01,
Near Police Thana Gate Ukhimath,
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Established-2025

Indexed in (HIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

Starting Year-2025
Multiple Languages:
Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu,
English, Punjabi Etc.
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Shreeshodhmantra
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वैधानिक चेतावनी

संदर्भित शोध-पत्रिका में प्रकाशित आलेख/शोध-पत्र प्रकाशक के कॉपीराइट के अधीन हैं। प्रकाशक की अनुमति के बिना प्रकाशन के किसी भी भाग की कॉपी/प्रतिलिपि अथवा पुनरुत्पादन नहीं किया जा सकता है। शोध-पत्रिका के किसी भी अंश के प्रकाशन- फोटोकॉपी, इलेक्ट्रॉनिक माध्यमों में उपयोग के लिए प्रकाशक की लिखित अनुमति आवश्यक है। शोध पत्रिका में निहित विचार लेखकों के हैं, प्रकाशक अथवा सम्पादकीय बोर्ड के नहीं। सम्पादक मण्डल का इनसे सहमत होना अनिवार्य नहीं है। शोध पत्रिका में प्रकाशित शोध-पत्रों में निहित विचार तथा संदर्भों का सम्पूर्ण दायित्व स्वयं लेखकों का है साहित्यिक चोरी के लिए लेखक स्वयं उत्तरदायी है। सम्पादक-मण्डल/प्रकाशक इसके लिए उत्तरदायी नहीं हैं। सभी पाठकों को सूचित किया जाता है कि लेखक, सम्पादक अथवा प्रकाशक कार्य के आधार पर की गई किसी भी क्षति/हानि के परिणामस्वरूप न्यायिक क्षेत्र केवल (उखीमठ) ही मान्य होगा। फलतः किसी भी क्षति/हानि के लिए सम्पादक-बोर्ड/प्रकाशक जिम्मेदार नहीं है। शोध पत्र का संपादन पत्रिका के संपादकों/सम्पादक मण्डल (विशेषज्ञ समिति) द्वारा किया जा सकता है। जिसे विभिन्न मूल्यांकन स्तरों से गुजरना पड़ता है। लेखकों को ध्यान रखना चाहिए कि स्वीकृत लेख संपादन के किसी भी स्तर पर संपादकों/पियर रिव्यू टीम (विशेषज्ञ समिति) द्वारा आवश्यक संशोधनों परिवर्तनों के अधीन है।

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International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal

(An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)

International Standard Serial Number Print (ISSN): 3107-4901

Year-2025 (1), Volume-1, ISSUE-3, July To September, Frequency-Quarterly



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Published by SSM Publication, Ukhimath

Publication Address: SSM Publication, Maddmaheshwar Road Ukhimath, Gandhinagar Ward No-01,
Near Police Thana Gate Ukhimath, District-Rudraprayag (Uttarakhand) Pin-246469

Mobile: +91 9410900852, Email: shodhmantrapublication@gmail.com

Editorial Office: Shreeshodhmantra, Research Journal, Ukhimath

Address: Gandhinagar Ward No-01, Near Police Thana Gate Ukhimath, District-Rudraprayag,
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Established-2025 Starting Year-2025 Multiple Languages: Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu, English, Punjabi Etc. (All Regional Languages)	Indexed in (IIFS) Impact Factor: 3.0	International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901 Year-2025(1) Volume-1 Issue: 3 (July to September) Quarterly
	Shreeshodhmantra International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal (An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)	

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Journal Particulars

Title	Shreeshodhmantra, International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal (An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)
Frequency	Quarterly
Print (ISSN)	3107-4901
Publisher	SSM Publication, Ukhimath Address: SSM Publication, Maddmaheshwar Road Ukhimath, Gandhinagar Ward No-01, Near Police Thana Gate Ukhimath, District- Rudraprayag (Uttarakhand) Pin-246469 Mobile: +91 9410900852 Email: shodhmantrapublication@gmail.com
Chief Editor	Dr.Okendra
Copyright	Shreeshodhmantra, International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal (An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)
Starting Year	2025
Subject	Multidisciplinary
Language	Multiple Languages: Hindi, Sanskrit, English, Urdu, Punjabi Etc. (All Regional Languages)
Publication Format	Print
Phone No.	01364264359
Email Id	shreeshodhmantra@gmail.com
Mobile No.	+91 7060641245
Publication Details	Year-2025(1) Volume-1 Issue: 3 (July to September) Quarterly
Address	Editorial Office: Shreeshodhmantra, Research Journal, Ukhimath Address: Gandhinagar Ward No.01, Near Police Thana Gate Ukhimath, District- Rudraprayag (Uttarakhand) Pin-246469 Mobile: +91 7060641245 Email Id: shreeshodhmantra@gmail.com

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अनुक्रमणिका (INDEX)

S.NO.	INTERNATIONAL STANDARD SERIAL NUMBER PRINT (ISSN): 3107-4901 YEAR-2025 (1) VOLUME-1 ISSUE: 3 [July to September] Frequency-Quarterly PUBLISHED IN: Shreeshodhmantra : International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal (An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)	PAGE NO.
01-	Authors: प्रो. डॉ० वि.के. सुब्रमण्यन, पुष्पा सी.वी. Paper Title: सुनीता जैन की कविताओं में वृद्ध जीवन	23-30
02-	Authors: डॉ० मन्जु कोगियाल Paper Title: उत्तरखण्ड में पत्रकारिता का स्वरूप	31-37
03-	Authors: Prof. Dr. Sanjay Arun Marathe, Punam Sandip Warule Paper Title: Role of India in Foreign Policy	38-40
04-	Authors: डॉ० रीतू भटनागर Paper Title: नव संस्कृति और न्यू मीडिया	41-45
05-	Authors: डॉ० हिमांशु यादव Paper Title: भारत-म्यांमार सीमा पर अवैध आवाजन और प्रशासनिक उपाय : सुरक्षा, पहचान और नीति का संकट	46-53
06-	Authors: डॉ० जितेन्द्र कुमार Paper Title: भारतीय संस्कृति का मूलधार : आदिवासी समाज व संस्कृति	54-57
07-	Authors: डॉ० सुमेश कुमार Paper Title: भारतीय रक्षा अर्थव्यवस्था का सामरिक मूल्यांकन	58-64
08-	Authors: रमेश चन्द्र सेमवाल Paper Title: लोक साहित्य और संस्कृति का सामाजिक एवं ऐतिहासिक महत्व	65-67
09-	Authors: वैशाख के एस, डॉ० एप्सिलिन Paper Title: उत्तराधुनिक परिदृश्य में रणेंद्र का उपन्यास 'गायब होता देश'	68-72
10-	Authors: डॉ० मंजुला श्रीवास्तव Paper Title: लोक साहित्य और सामाजिक सुधार आन्दोलन : लोक कथा के सन्दर्भ में	73-75
11-	Authors: डॉ० उपदेश देवी Paper Title: समाचार पत्र के महत्व का सामाजिक मूल्यांकन	76-80
12-	Authors: Miss Malin Timungpi Paper Title: A Study on Customer's Satisfaction Towards Internet Banking Service with Reference to Nagaon District, Assam	81-87
13-	Authors: दीक्षा Paper Title: वर्तमान संदर्भ में लोक संस्कृति की प्रासंगिकता	88-92
14-	Authors: Dr. Rajni Bala Paper Title: Fragile Ties: The Decline of Attachment in Families in a Changing World	93-99

श्रीशोधमंत्र



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15-	Authors:	सुमित रंगा	100-104
	Paper Title:	बाजारवाद में लोक साहित्य की प्रासंगिकता	
16-	Authors:	डॉ० सन्मुख नागनाथ मुक्छे	105-113
	Paper Title:	मोहनदास नैमिशराय के 'आग और आंदोलन' काव्य-संग्रह में दलित समाज	
17-	Authors:	पी. यादव 'ओज'	114-122
	Paper Title:	देश की आजादी में महिलाओं का योगदान	
18-	Authors:	राम भरोसी बैरवा	123-128
	Paper Title:	डॉ० सूरज सिंह नेगी के कथा साहित्य में शैलिक वैशिष्ट्य	
19-	Authors:	प्रास्नेहा प्रदीप हिंगमिरे	129-133
	Paper Title:	प्रयोजनमूलक हिंदी की आवश्यकता और महत्व	
20-	Authors:	कैप्टन डॉ० ज्ञानेश्वरसेनेरावविठ्ठलपटले	134-141
	Paper Title:	शिवानी के साहित्य में स्त्री जीवन और सामाजिक यथार्थ का चित्रण	
21-	Authors:	शितल सचिन खैरमोडे	142-144
	Paper Title:	व्यंग्यकार हरिशंकर परसाई के साहित्य में विप्रित भ्रष्टाचार	
22-	Authors:	डॉ० राजाराम जी. शेवाले	145-149
	Paper Title:	उच्च शिक्षा में स्थायी विकास का मूल मार्ग : राष्ट्रीय शिक्षा नीति 2020	
23-	Authors:	डॉ० यल. कोमुर रेडी	150-155
	Paper Title:	धर्मवीर भारती की 'कनुप्रिया' और आधुनिक प्रासंगिकता : प्रेम, युद्ध और मानवीय चेतना	
24-	Authors:	डॉ० सन्त कुमार तिवारी	156-162
	Paper Title:	वर्तमान परिप्रेक्ष्य में नई शिक्षा नीति की उपादेयता एवं भविष्यगामी लक्ष्य और चुनौतियाँ	
25-	Authors:	डॉ० श्रीकांत पाटील	163-167
	Paper Title:	लोकगीतों का औचित्य सौंदर्य : 'अगम बहै दरियाव'	
26-	Authors:	विवेचना पाण्डेय	168-173
	Paper Title:	मध्यप्रदेश भू-राजस्व संहिता 1959 ई०	
27-	Authors:	Dinesh Chandra Rankawat "Dwiz"	174-181
	Paper Title:	Climate Change and International Trade : The Impact of Carbon Tax and Green Energy Investment	
28-	Authors:	महेर दीपाश्री मुकेशभाई	182-185
	Paper Title:	महुआरों का जीवन : एक संघर्ष	
29-	Authors:	श्री मारुति भीमण्णा	186-192
	Paper Title:	प्रेमचन्दजी की कहानियों में दलित वर्ग	
30-	Authors:	डॉ० गोविन्द कुमार	193-198
	Paper Title:	भर्तृहरि विरचित नीतिशतकम् में नैतिक शिक्षा का स्वरूप	
31-	Authors:	डॉ० शैलजा हेव. जी.	199-201
	Paper Title:	दलित स्त्री का आत्मबल और सामाजिक परिवर्तन	
32-	Authors:	रंजना शर्मा	202-206
	Paper Title:	चित्तौड़गढ़ के आधुनिक कालीन साहित्य में राष्ट्रीय चेतना	

श्रीशोधमंत्र

अंतरराष्ट्रीय बहुविषयक शैक्षणिक रिसर्च जर्नल
(अंतरराष्ट्रीय बहुविषयक पियर रिव्यूड एवं रेफरीड 'समीक्षित एवं मूल्यांकित' शोध पत्रिका)

Established-2025

Indexed in (HIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

Starting Year-2025
Multiple Languages:
Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu,
English, Punjabi Etc.
(All Regional Languages)



Shreeshodhmantra
International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
(An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)

33-	Authors:	डॉ० जाकिर हुसैन गुलगुंदी	207-211
	Paper Title:	समकालीन उपन्यास साहित्य में शहरीकरण और युवा वर्ग	
34-	Authors:	डॉ० सीमा रानी	212-219
	Paper Title:	तुलसीदास और तुलनात्मक साहित्य: रामचरितमानस का वैश्विक महाकाव्यों से संवाद	
35-	Authors:	यशोदे मुक्ति शशिकांतभाई, डॉ० भावेश वी जाधव	220-222
	Paper Title:	दलित आत्मकथा : एक जीवंत सामाजिक दस्तावेज	
36-	Authors:	प्रियंका देवी	223-230
	Paper Title:	जीवन प्रबन्धन के परिप्रेक्ष्य में भारतीय दर्शन एवं योग की भूमिका	
37-	Authors:	उमेश पाण्डेय, डॉ० राजकुमारी शर्मा	231-233
	Paper Title:	मध्यप्रदेश का गौरव लोकनाट्य "माव"	
38-	Authors:	डॉ० चंद्रेखाशर्मा	234-240
	Paper Title:	राजस्थानी लोक साहित्य में लोकगीतों और लोक गाथाओं का रचना संसार	
39-	Authors:	डॉ० सरिता भवानी मालवीय	241-249
	Paper Title:	कृत्रिम बुद्धिमत्ता (एआई) सहायता प्राप्त नैदानिक निर्णयों में उत्तरदायित्व : विधिक एवं नैतिक	
40-	Authors:	धर्मेन्द्र शास्त्री	250-255
	Paper Title:	सामुदायिक रेडियो प्रसारण से ग्रामीण समुदाय में सूचना का प्रसार और सामाजिक विकास : बिहार के संदर्भ में	
41-	Authors:	डॉ० राजेश, डॉ० पारुल	256-259
	Paper Title:	श्रद्धा, संघर्ष और सौंदर्य की अजूबी अनुभूति केदारनाथ यात्रा : एक विवेचन	
42-	Authors:	Amandeep K Minhas, Dr. Rajesh	260-275
	Paper Title:	Workplace Mental Health Through a Developmental Lens: Exploring Psychosocial Growth Among Young Corporate Professionals in India	
43-	Authors:	डॉ० नवनाथ गाडेकर	276-281
	Paper Title:	भारतीय ज्ञान प्रणाली और अति साहित्य की प्रसंगिकता	
44-	Authors:	प्रा. वाघचौरि अशोक भावराव	282-286
	Paper Title:	भारतीय पौराणिक कथाओं में बहुसंस्कृतिवाद	
45-	Authors:	मलक सिंघ	287-291
	Paper Title:	गिआनी एमर सिंघ नारा ਦੀ ਸਿੱਖ ਚਿੰਤਕ ਅਤੇ ਗੁਰਮਤਿ ਸਾਹਿਤ ਸੇਵੀ ਵਜੋਂ ਭੂਮਿਕਾ	
46-	Authors:	Amandeep Kaur	292-295
	Paper Title:	HISTORICAL BACKGROUND OF MGNREGA	
47-	Authors:	Jaswinder Ralh	296-300
	Paper Title:	Theme Centric Approach and Character Centric Approach in Indian English Literature: A Critical Study	
48-	Authors:	Ramplejeet Singh	301-304
	Paper Title:	Indo-US Bilateral Relationship: Historical Perspective	
49-	Authors:	संदीप कुमार, डॉ० दिनेश मंडोत	305-307
	Paper Title:	कुरुक्षेत्र के सामाजिक और आर्थिक विकास में मनरेगा का योगदान	

श्रीशोधमंत्र



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Established-2025

Indexed in (IIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

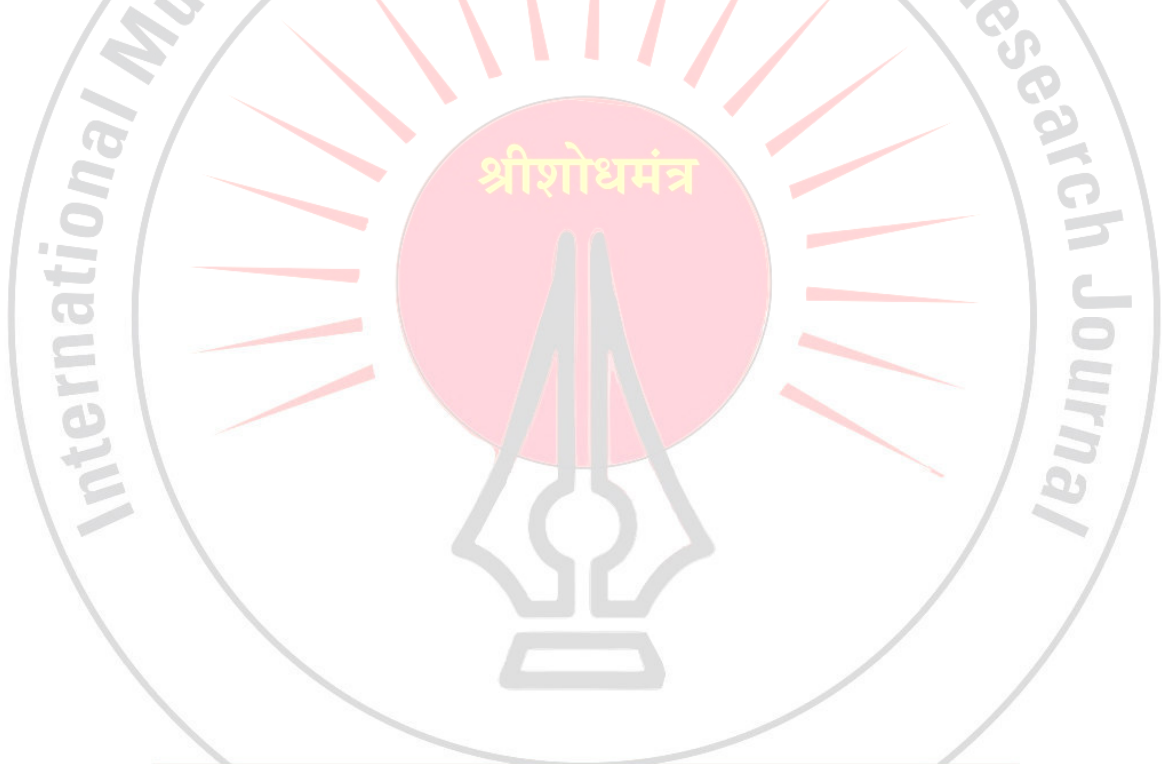
International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

Starting Year-2025
Multiple Languages:
Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu,
English, Punjabi Etc.
(All Regional Languages)



Shreeshodhmantra
International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
(An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)

50-	Authors: Sewak Singh	308-312
	Paper Title: Indo-US Strategic Partnership in the 21st Century	
51-	Authors: डॉ० अजय गोयल	313-316
	Paper Title: मुंशी प्रेमचंद की कहानी 'ठाकुर का कुआँ' : सामाजिक यथार्थ और दलित चेतना	
52-	Authors: Sayed Amir Mustafa Hashmi, Dr. Ashutosh Mandavi, Dr. Nripendra Kumar Sharma	317-324
	Paper Title: Corporate Social Responsibility Communication and Beneficiary Perceptions in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand	
53-	Authors:	
	Paper Title:	



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श्रीशोधमंत्र



अंतराष्ट्रीय बहुविषयक शैक्षणिक रिसर्च जर्नल
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Established-2025Indexed in (IIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | QuarterlyStarting Year-2025
Multiple Languages:
Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu,
English, Punjabi Etc.
(All Regional Languages)**Shreeshodhmantra**
International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
(An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)

(52) Paper Published in July - September 2025 Received:28/09/2025 Accepted:30/09/2025	Corporate Social Responsibility Communication and Beneficiary Perceptions in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand
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Abstract: Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has become an important part of how companies contribute to society in India, especially after the Companies Act of 2013 made it compulsory for certain companies to spend money on social welfare. While many studies have looked at how much money companies spend on CSR, very few have examined how companies talk to communities about their work. This study explores how companies communicate with local communities about their CSR projects in two Indian states—Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. Both states are rich in minerals like coal and iron ore, but they also face challenges like poverty, low literacy, and limited healthcare access. The research examined 20 CSR projects across 10 districts in each state by studying company reports, NGO documents, and media coverage. The findings show that communication is extremely important for CSR success. In Chhattisgarh, companies mostly use village meetings, community radio, and local NGOs to talk to people, which works well in areas where many cannot read or write. In Jharkhand, companies often combine digital tools like mobile phones and social media with face-to-face meetings, especially for health and education projects. People trust CSR projects more when they are involved in discussions and when information is shared clearly in local languages. The study concludes that CSR communication should not be one-way announcements but a two-way conversation that builds trust and ensures projects truly help communities.

Keywords: CSR communication, community development, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, stakeholder engagement, tribal communities

1. Introduction

1.1 What is CSR and Why Does It Matter?

Corporate Social Responsibility, or CSR, means that companies have a duty to give back to society. In India, the Companies Act of 2013 made it compulsory for big companies to spend at least 2% of their profits on social welfare activities. These activities include building schools, running health camps, protecting the environment, and helping people earn a living. This law made India the first country in the world to legally require companies to spend money on social development.

But spending money is not enough. For CSR projects to actually help people, communities need to know about them, understand them, and participate in them. This is where communication becomes crucial. CSR communication means how companies share information about their projects with local people—through meetings, pamphlets, radio, television, social media, or word of mouth.

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Established-2025

Indexed in (IIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

Starting Year-2025
Multiple Languages:
Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu,
English, Punjabi Etc.
(All Regional Languages)



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1.2 Why Study Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand?

Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand are two states in eastern and central India that were both formed in the year 2000. They have three important things in common:

1. **Rich in minerals** – Both states have large deposits of coal, iron ore, and limestone. Many mining and steel companies operate here.
2. **Large tribal populations** – About 30% of people in Chhattisgarh and 26% in Jharkhand belong to tribal communities. These communities often live in remote areas with limited access to schools, hospitals, and other services.
3. **Development challenges** – Despite having many industries, both states face problems like poverty, malnutrition, low literacy, and poor healthcare.

Because of these similarities, these two states are perfect for comparing how companies communicate their CSR work to local communities. Understanding what works and what doesn't can help companies design better projects that actually benefit people.

1.3 What This Study Tries to Find Out

This research had five main goals:

1. To compare how well CSR communication works in Chhattisgarh versus Jharkhand
2. To see if CSR communication helps improve education in both states
3. To understand whether CSR communication makes healthcare more accessible
4. To examine if CSR communication helps people care more about the environment
5. To find out if CSR communication helps create jobs and improve people's livelihoods

2. How CSR Communication Works: A Simple Explanation

2.1 The CSR Process in Simple Terms

Think of CSR like this: A company decides to help a village. They might build a school, run a health camp, or teach women how to start small businesses. But for this help to actually reach people, the company needs to tell the villagers about it. This is communication.

The CSR process has four simple steps:

Step 1: Planning – The company decides what to do and where to do it. They might talk to village leaders to understand what people actually need.

Step 2: Doing – The company works with local NGOs (non-government groups) to run the project. They build the school or organize the health camp.

Step 3: Impact – People start benefiting. Children go to school, sick people get treatment, women learn new skills.

Step 4: Communicating – The company tells people about the project—what it is, who can benefit, how to participate, and what has been achieved.

2.2 Different Ways Companies Talk to Communities

Companies use many different ways to communicate with local people:

Communication Method	What It Means	Where It Works Best
Village meetings	Talking directly to people in gatherings	Rural and tribal areas where people trust face-to-face talk
Community radio	Broadcasting information in local languages	Areas where people cannot read or write
Posters and wall paintings	Putting up information visually	Villages where people pass by regularly
Pamphlets and brochures	Giving printed materials	Areas with moderate literacy
Mobile phones and SMS	Sending text messages	Places with phone coverage

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Established-2025

Indexed in (IIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

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(All Regional Languages)



Shreeshodhmantra
International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
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Social media	Using Facebook, WhatsApp, etc.	Urban and semi-urban areas with internet
TV and newspapers	Using mass media	Cities and towns
NGO partners	Working through trusted local groups	Everywhere, especially remote areas

2.3 Why Good Communication Matters

Good communication is not just about telling people things. It helps in five important ways:

1. **Awareness** – People know what help is available and how to get it
2. **Trust** – When companies are open and honest, people trust them more
3. **Participation** – People join in and help make projects successful
4. **Feedback** – Companies learn what's working and what needs to change
5. **Sustainability** – Projects continue to help people even after the company leaves

Bad communication, on the other hand, leads to confusion, mistrust, and wasted resources. People might not use a new school if they don't know it exists or don't trust who built it.

3. How We Did This Research

3.1 Our Approach

This study used a mixed-methods approach, which means we used both numbers and stories to understand CSR communication.

Quantitative part: We surveyed 400 people who had directly benefited from CSR projects—200 in Chhattisgarh and 200 in Jharkhand. We asked them simple questions about whether they knew about CSR projects, how they got information, and whether they thought the projects helped.

Qualitative part: We had detailed conversations with 40 important people—CSR managers from companies, NGO workers, government officials, and community leaders. They told us about their experiences, challenges, and what they thought worked best.

3.2 Where We Did the Research

We chose five main districts in each state, plus other districts where CSR was active:

Chhattisgarh: Raipur, Dhamtari, Balodabazar, Kanker, Bastar, plus other districts

Jharkhand: East Singhbhum (Jamshedpur), West Singhbhum (Chaibasa), Ranchi, Ramgarh, Hazaribagh, plus other districts

These districts were chosen because they have lots of companies doing CSR work and because they include both cities and remote tribal areas.

3.3 What We Looked At

For each CSR project, we checked five things:

1. **Which company** was doing the work
2. **Who implemented** the project – the company itself or a local NGO
3. **What type** of project – education, health, environment, or livelihood
4. **What impact** it had – did it actually help people?
5. **How they communicated** – what methods they used and how well they worked

4. What We Found: CSR in Chhattisgarh

4.1 How Much Companies Spend

In the financial year 2023-24, Chhattisgarh received ₹422.73 crore (about 50 million US dollars) in CSR funds from 353 companies. The top three districts getting money were:

- **Raipur:** ₹110.42 crore – mostly for education and health
- **Korba:** ₹17.98 crore – mainly for environment and livelihoods
- **Bilaspur:** ₹12.9 crore – focused on education and health

The biggest companies spending on CSR in Chhattisgarh were Jindal Steel, South Eastern Coalfields (SECL), NMDC, and HDFC Bank.

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Indexed in (IIFS)
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(An International Multidisciplinary Peer Reviewed & Refereed Research Journal)

4.2 How Companies Talk to Communities

In Chhattisgarh, companies mostly use traditional, face-to-face ways of communicating:

- **85% of projects** used village meetings to spread awareness
- **70% of districts** used community radio, especially in tribal areas
- **90% of rural areas** used posters and wall paintings
- **60% of urban districts** used social media like Facebook and WhatsApp

4.3 What People Think About CSR

Our survey showed that people in Chhattisgarh generally feel positive about CSR:

- **78% of people** knew about CSR projects in their area
- **86% said** CSR activities had visible impact
- **82% agreed** that CSR improved education
- **79% said** healthcare became more accessible
- **72% believed** environmental projects helped

One interesting finding: 80% of people in Chhattisgarh said they received CSR information in their local language, and 86% found the information clear and simple.

4.4 What Works Best in Chhattisgarh

The most successful projects in Chhattisgarh used village meetings and worked through local NGOs. People trusted information more when it came from someone they knew—like a village leader, a local teacher, or a respected NGO worker.

In Bastar and other tribal districts, companies used storytelling, folk songs, and community radio in local languages like Gondi and Halbi. This made people feel included and respected.

5. What We Found: CSR in Jharkhand

5.1 How Much Companies Spend

Between 2020-21 and 2023-24, Jharkhand received about ₹808 crore (97 million US dollars) in CSR funds. The top districts were:

- **East Singhbhum:** ₹12.24 crore – home to Tata Steel's headquarters
- **Ranchi:** ₹11.64 crore – the state capital
- **Dhanbad:** ₹6.64 crore – a major coal mining area

The biggest contributors were Tata Steel and HDFC Bank, focusing on education, health, and skill development.

5.2 How Companies Talk to Communities

Jharkhand shows a different pattern. Companies here use more digital and blended approaches:

- **80% of projects** used village meetings
- **65% of districts** used community radio
- **85% of rural areas** distributed printed materials
- **55% of urban districts** used social media
- **45% of districts** developed mobile apps for project updates

5.3 What People Think About CSR

In Jharkhand, people's views were slightly less positive than in Chhattisgarh:

- **65% of people** knew about CSR projects (compared to 78% in CG)
- **76% said** CSR had visible impact (compared to 86% in CG)
- **74% agreed** that CSR improved education
- **80% said** healthcare became more accessible (slightly better than CG)
- **60% believed** environmental projects helped

Only 54% of people in Jharkhand said they received CSR information in their local language, and 60% found the information clear.

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Established-2025

Indexed in (IIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

Starting Year-2025
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Shreeshodhmantra
International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
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5.4 What Works Best in Jharkhand

Despite lower overall numbers, Jharkhand does some things very well. Healthcare communication is particularly strong—mobile health units, health camps, and immunization drives reach many people. In Ranchi and Jamshedpur, digital literacy programs and mobile apps help track project progress.

In tribal areas like Chaibasa and Palamu, companies using storytelling and local languages like Ho and Santhali saw much better participation. When local youth leaders helped spread information, people trusted it more.

6. Comparing the Two States: Key Differences

6.1 Communication Methods Side by Side

Aspect	Chhattisgarh	Jharkhand
Main communication method	Village meetings, community radio	Mix of digital and face-to-face
Rural focus	Strong – traditional methods dominate	Moderate – digital tools reaching semi-urban areas
Local language use	80% of people get info in local language	54% of people get info in local language
Message clarity	86% find information clear	60% find information clear
Digital adoption	Lower, mostly in cities	Higher, especially for health and education
Best performing sector	Livelihood and education	Healthcare

6.2 What Explains These Differences?

Several factors explain why CSR communication works differently in these two states:

1. Company presence: In Chhattisgarh, many CSR projects are run by mining and power companies that have operated in rural areas for decades. They have built relationships with local communities and know how to talk to them.

In Jharkhand, Tata Steel's long history in Jamshedpur means they have sophisticated CSR programs, but these don't always reach remote tribal areas as effectively.

2. Geography: Chhattisgarh's tribal districts are more connected to each other, making community radio and village meetings effective. Jharkhand's terrain is more challenging, with many scattered villages, making digital tools more attractive.

3. Literacy and language: Both states have low literacy, but Chhattisgarh has done better at using oral communication methods like radio and meetings. Jharkhand's greater linguistic diversity makes communication more complex.

4. NGO presence: Both states have active NGOs, but Chhattisgarh's NGOs seem more involved in day-to-day communication with communities. In Jharkhand, companies often work directly with district officials, which can feel more top-down.

6.3 Surprising Findings

Two findings surprised us:

First, healthcare communication worked better in Jharkhand despite its overall communication challenges. Mobile health units and well-organized health camps reached people effectively. This shows that when communication is tied to a clear, needed service, it works better.

Second, people in Chhattisgarh were much more likely to say CSR improved their "overall quality of life" (80% vs 62% in Jharkhand). This suggests that good communication doesn't just spread information—it makes people feel more positive about development in general.

7. Challenges in CSR Communication

7.1 Common Problems in Both States

Despite their differences, both states face similar challenges:

Language barriers: Many CSR materials are in Hindi or English, but tribal communities speak Gondi, Halbi, Ho, Santhali, and other languages. When information isn't in their language, people don't understand or trust it.

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Established-2025

Indexed in (IIFS)
Impact Factor: 3.0

International Standard Serial Number (Print) ISSN: 3107-4901
Year-2025(1) | Volume-1 | Issue: 3 (July to September) | Quarterly

Starting Year-2025
Multiple Languages:
Hindi, Sanskrit, Urdu,
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Shreeshodhmantra
International Multidisciplinary Academic Research Journal
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Low literacy: In remote areas, many people cannot read. Pamphlets and posters don't work. Companies need to use radio, meetings, and visual methods.

Digital divide: While cities have good internet, many villages don't. Digital campaigns miss the poorest and most remote communities.

Top-down communication: Too often, companies decide what to do and then tell communities, rather than asking them first. This creates distrust.

Short-term projects: Many CSR projects last only 1-2 years. Just as communities start to trust the company, the project ends. This creates skepticism.

7.2 Problems Specific to Each State

In Chhattisgarh:

- Maoist insurgency in Bastar and Dantewada makes it dangerous for company staff to visit villages
- Communities displaced by mining often distrust companies
- Some CSR money gets spent on political projects rather than community needs

In Jharkhand:

- Greater linguistic diversity makes communication more complex
- Urban bias means remote tribal areas get less attention
- Elite capture – benefits often go to connected families rather than the poorest

8. What Makes CSR Communication Work: Lessons from the Field

8.1 The Most Effective Methods

Based on our research, here's what works best:

1. **Village meetings with local leaders** – When respected community members explain projects, people trust and participate. In Korba, farmer training programs had 85% participation when local farmers helped spread the word.
2. **Community radio in local languages** – In Bastar, health messages on community radio reached 65% of households, compared to 32% for pamphlets. People remember what they hear on radio.
3. **Working through women's self-help groups** – In Balodabazar, women's groups helped spread information about sanitation. Adoption of hygiene practices increased by 41%.
4. **Combining methods** – The best projects use multiple channels. A health camp in Godda used mobile alerts, village meetings, and posters. Participation was 40% higher than camps using just one method.
5. **Feedback mechanisms** – Projects with suggestion boxes, helplines, or regular community meetings for feedback had 18-20% higher satisfaction. People feel heard when they can share their views.

8.2 The Power of Local Languages

One of our clearest findings is that **local language matters enormously**. When companies use local languages:

- Comprehension increases by 22-25%
- Trust is significantly higher
- Women and elders participate more
- Projects are seen as "ours" rather than "theirs"

In Chaibasa, a nutrition campaign in Ho language increased mid-day meal participation by 22%. In Bastar, health jingles in Gondi were remembered by 30% more people than Hindi posters.

8.3 The Importance of Two-Way Communication

The most successful projects don't just tell people things—they listen. Two-way communication means:

- Asking communities what they need before planning projects
- Having regular meetings where people can ask questions
- Taking feedback seriously and changing projects based on it
- Sharing results and progress openly

In Raigarh, companies that shared project progress at village meetings saw trust increase by 32%. People appreciated knowing what had been achieved and what was still planned.

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9. Recommendations: How to Make CSR Communication Better

9.1 For Companies

1. Use more local languages

Stop relying only on Hindi and English. Translate materials into local languages. Train staff to speak with communities in their own language. In Jharkhand, this means Ho, Santhali, Mundari, and Kurukh. In Chhattisgarh, it means Gondi, Halbi, and Chhattisgarhi.

2. Combine traditional and digital methods

Don't abandon face-to-face communication for digital tools. Use both. In rural areas, start with village meetings and community radio. Add mobile alerts and social media for younger people. In cities, use digital tools but don't forget personal contact.

3. Work through trusted local partners

NGOs, self-help groups, and village leaders are trusted by communities. Partner with them for communication. In Korba, projects working through local NGOs had 25% higher trust levels.

4. Create feedback systems

Set up simple ways for people to share their views—suggestion boxes at project sites, toll-free helplines, regular community meetings. Use this feedback to improve projects.

5. Be transparent

Share information about budgets, timelines, and results. When people know how money is spent, they trust more. Display project information at panchayat offices. Share simple reports in local languages.

9.2 For Government

1. Strengthen district CSR cells

Help districts track CSR communication better. Create simple reporting formats that capture not just how much money was spent, but how well people were informed and involved.

2. Encourage communication audits

Just as companies audit their finances, they should audit their communication. Check whether messages are clear, inclusive, and reaching the right people.

3. Support community media

Help community radio stations and local newspapers cover CSR work. This builds awareness and accountability.

4. Facilitate partnerships

Bring companies, NGOs, and local media together to share best practices. What works in one district might work in another.

9.3 For NGOs and Community Organizations

1. Be active intermediaries

You are trusted by communities. Use this trust to help companies communicate better. Explain projects in ways people understand. Bring community concerns back to companies.

2. Train local communicators

Identify and train local youth, women leaders, and village elders to spread information. They know the community and its language.

3. Document and share

Keep records of what communication methods work. Share these lessons with companies and other NGOs.

10. Conclusion

10.1 What We Learned

This study compared CSR communication in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand and found clear differences in how companies talk to communities and how well that communication works.

In Chhattisgarh, companies rely heavily on traditional methods—village meetings, community radio, and local NGOs. This approach builds trust and reaches people even in remote areas. Communication is often in local languages, and people find it clear. As a result, awareness is high (78%), and most people feel CSR has improved their lives (80%).

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In Jharkhand, companies use more digital tools alongside traditional methods. While this works well in cities and for some sectors like healthcare, it leaves many tribal and rural communities behind. Only 54% receive information in their local language, and 40% find communication unclear. Awareness (65%) and quality-of-life perception (62%) are lower. The most important lesson is simple: CSR communication works best when it is a two-way conversation, not a one-way announcement. When companies listen to communities, use local languages, work through trusted local partners, and share information openly, people trust them more and participate more actively.

10.2 Why This Matters

This matters because CSR in India is not just about spending money—it's about actually helping people. The Companies Act of 2013 requires companies to contribute to social development, but money alone doesn't create development. People need to know about projects, understand them, trust them, and participate in them. Communication makes this possible.

In states like Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, where tribal communities have often been exploited and marginalized, good communication is especially important. It shows respect. It builds relationships. It ensures that development actually reaches the people who need it most.

10.3 Final Thought

CSR communication is not an extra or an afterthought—it is at the heart of whether CSR succeeds or fails. A school that no one knows about won't be used. A health camp that people don't trust won't be attended. A skill training program that women don't understand won't help anyone earn a living.

Companies that understand this and invest in good communication will see their CSR money go further. Communities that are informed and involved will benefit more. And over time, the trust built through good communication can transform relationships between companies and communities, making development truly sustainable.

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